

PROJECT DOCUMENTATION

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Introduction:

**Project Title : Streamlining IT Procurement:Automating Standard Laptop
Orders with Flow Designer**

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➤ Problem Statement:

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

➤ User Story:

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are

promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

➤ **Project Objective:**

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

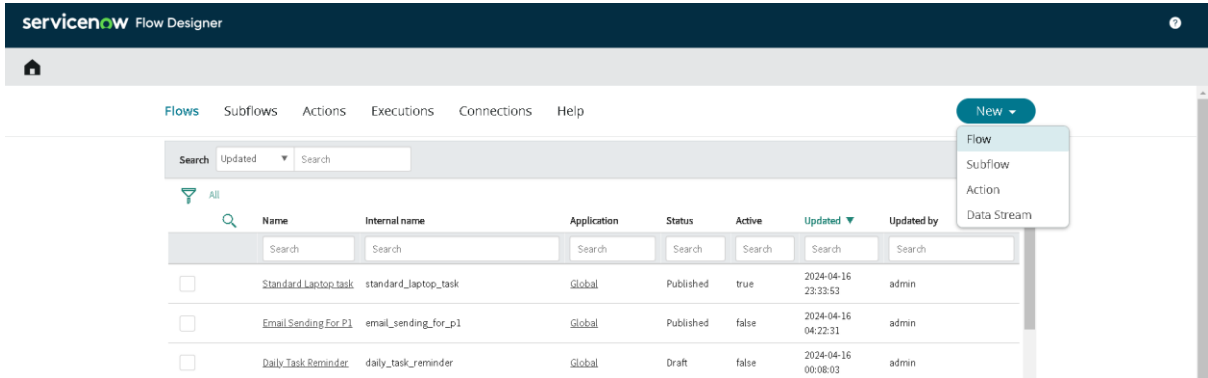
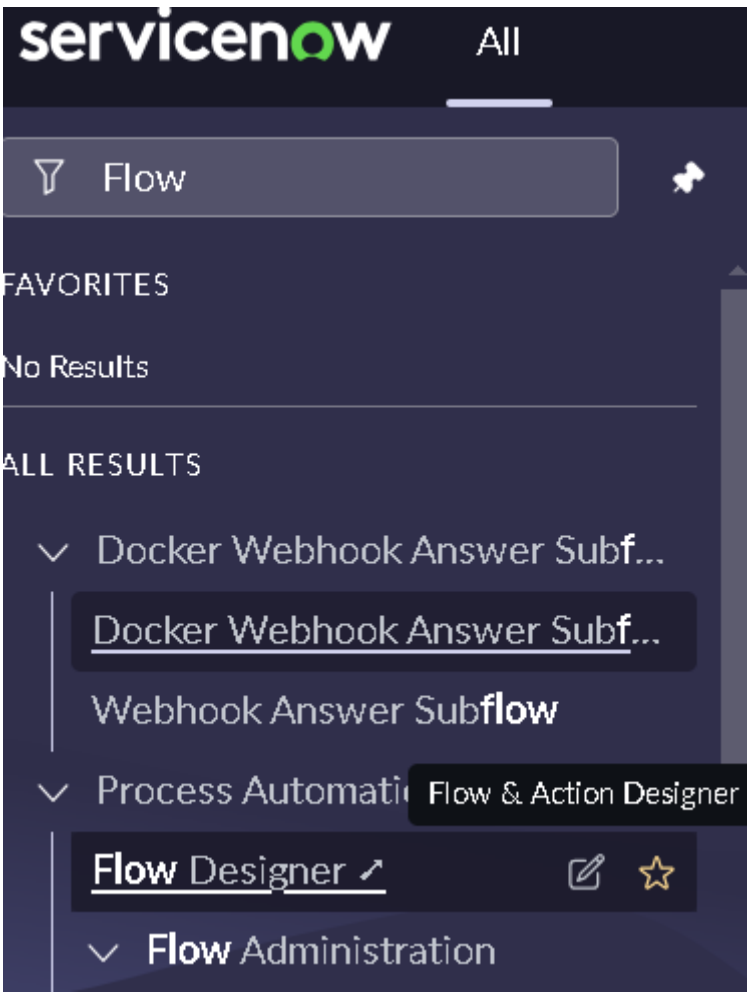
- Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
- Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
- Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
- Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

TASK INITIATION

Milestone 1 : Flow

Activity 1: Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.

- Open service now.
- Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
- Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
- After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
- Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “ Standard laptop task”.
- Application should be Global.
- Select Run user as “ System user ” from that choice.
- Click on Submit.



Flow properties

* Flow name

Description

Describe your flow

Application

Global

Protection

-- None --

Run As

System User

Cancel

Submit

- Click on Add a trigger
- Select the trigger in that Search for “Service Catalog ” and select that.
- After that click on Done.

Flow VPN

Flow Email sending for P1

Flow Standard laptop task

Standard laptop task

Inactive

View:

TRIGGER

Abort trigger creation

Trigger

Select a Trigger

Search triggers

RECORD

Created

Updated

Created or Updated

DATE

Daily

Created

Trigger initiates from a ServiceNow record creation that meets the condition filter.

ACTIONS

Add an Action, Flow

ERROR HANDLER

TRIGGER


Service Catalog




Trigger

Service Catalog

Advanced Options

Delete
Cancel
Done

- Now under Actions.
- Click on Add an action.
- Select action in that search for “ Create Catalog Task ” and select that.
- Mention these in that action
- Action as Create Catalog Task
- Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
- Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
- Mention the short description as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
- Click on add field value
- Select description field and value as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
- Select Assignment group field and value as “ Hardware ”.
- Select Approval field and value as “ Approved ”.
- Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.
- Click on save the Flow.
- And Click on Activate again click on Activate.



Standard Laptop task

Active

✕ Action Flow Logic Subflow

Search Actions

Create Catalog Task

Most Recent

Popular

INSTALLED SPOKES

- ServiceNow Core
- Connect
- AES Portal UI Template
- Deployment Pipeline
- Virtual Agent
- Password Reset
- AES Flow Templates
- Global

Create Catalog Task
ServiceNow Core

Look Up Record
ServiceNow Core

Wait For Condition
ServiceNow Core

Create Record
ServiceNow Core

SLA Percentage Timer
ServiceNow Core

Send Email
ServiceNow Core

Update Record
ServiceNow Core

Create Template ACL



Standard Laptop task

Active

View: [Icon] [Icon]

Test

De

1 Create Catalog Task ⓘ

Action: Create Catalog Task

Table Name: Catalog Task [sc_task]

* Requested Item [Requested Item]: Trigger - ... ▶ Requested Item ...

Short Description: Laptop needs to Configured

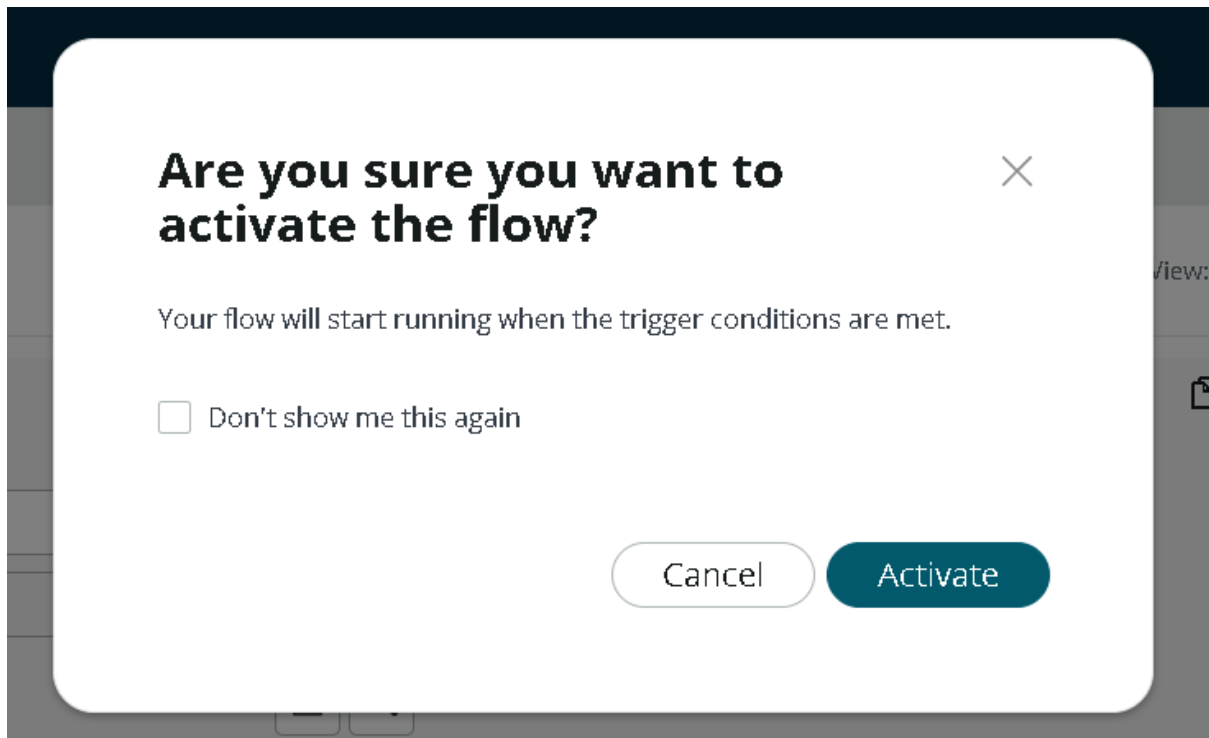
Fields:

Description	X	Laptop needs to Configured	[Icon] [Icon] [Icon]
Assignment group	X	Hardware	[Icon] [Icon] [Icon]
Approval	X	Approved	[Icon] [Icon] [Icon]

+ Add field value

Wait: ☒

Template Catalog: Select Template Catalog Item



Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

- Open ServiceNow.
- Click on all search for Maintain Items.
- Select Maintain Items.
- Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
- Under that record select Process engine
- Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
- Add the flow that was created with the name “ Standard Laptop Task”.
- Click on the menu to save the record.

servicenow

mainta

FAVORITES

No Results

ALL RESULTS

- Service Catalog
 - Catalog Definitions
 - Maintain Catalogs
 - Maintain Categories
 - Maintain Dynamic Categories
 - Maintain Items
 - Maintain Cart Layouts
 - Service Catalog Wizards
 - Maintain Wizards

Catalog Items

for text

Search

Actions on selected rows...

New

All > Type != Bundle > Class != Order guide > Type != Package > Class != Content Item > Published item is empty > Name starts with standard

Name	Short description	Active	Roles	Catalogs	Category	Price	Type	Updated
standard	Search	Search	Search	Search	Search	Search	!=Package	Search
Standard Laptop	Lenovo - Carbonx1	true		Service Catalog	Hardware	\$1,100.00	Item	2024-04-16 04:14:53
Standard 27" Monitor	Size - 27"; Resolution - 1920x1080, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$0.00	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
Standard 22" Monitor	Full HD, IPS Panel with VGA, HDMI, DVI, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$200.00	Item	2016-03-08 16:49:50
Standard 24" Monitor	TUV-certified Monitor Has Flicker-free S...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$292.28	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33

Catalog Item Standard Laptop

Update Copy Try It Edit in Catalog Builder De

Name Standard Laptop Application Global ⓘ

Catalogs Service Catalog Active ☒

Category Hardware ⓘ Fulfillment automation level Unspecified

State -- None --

Checked out -- None --

Owner ⓘ

Item Details Process Engine Picture Pricing Portal Settings

Select the appropriate process engine for the catalog item. Only one engine can be selected.

Flow Standard Laptop task ⓘ

Workflow ⓘ

Execution Plan ⓘ

Update Copy Try It Edit in Catalog Builder Delete

Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

Activity 1: Service Catalog for placing order and get Approval

- Click on All >> Search for “ Service Catalog ”.
- Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.
- Scroll a bit to find the “ Standard Laptop ” click on that.
- After that click on “ Order Now ” to place the request.

FavoritesHistoryWorkspacesAdmin

Standard Laptop

Search

🌐🔍🕒🔔👤

<Service Catalog>Hardware>Standard Laptop

🔍 Search catalog

Lenovo - Carbon x1

x1 Carbon

The x1 Carbon is Lenovo's lightest ThinkPad yet. It provides a QHD display that fights glare and weighs less than three pounds. Ideal for most computing tasks, and highly mobile.

Technical Specs:

- Intel core i5 processor
- 512GB solid state drive (SSD)
- Backlit keyboard

Optional Software

☐ Adobe Acrobat

☐ Adobe Photoshop

Additional software requirements

Order this Item

Price

₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Quantity

1

Subtotal

₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Delivery

Order Now

0 Days

Order Now

Add to Cart

Shopping Cart

Empty

- Now we will see the Order status
- In that click on the Request Number

Order Status

Back to CatalogContinue ShoppingHome

Thank you, your request has been submitted

Order Placed:

2024-04-17 04:07:11

Request Number:

REQ0010001

Estimated Delivery Date of Complete Order:

2024-04-17

Description (Includes Annual Charges)	Delivery Date	Stage	Price (ea.)	Quantity	Total
Lenovo - Carbon x1	2024-04-17		₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually	1	₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually
Total					₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Back to CatalogContinue Shopping

Home

- It will open the Requested number record.
- Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.

FavoritesHistoryWorkspacesAdmin

Request - REQ0010001

Search

🌐🔍🕒🔔👤

<Request REQ0010001

🔍🔍🔍🔍

DiscussFollowUpdateAdd New ItemCancel RequestCopyDelete

Short description

Special instructions

UpdateAdd New ItemCancel RequestCopyDelete

Related Links

Show WorkflowWorkflow Context

Requested Items (1)Approvers (1)Recurring Prices (1)

State

Search

Actions on selected rows...

Edit

Approval for = REQ0010001

State	Approver	Comments	Created
Requested	Eric Schroeder		2024-04-17 04:07:12

1 to 1 of 1

- Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.

[Update](#) [Add New Item](#) [Cancel Request](#) [Copy](#) [Delete](#)

Related Links

[Show Workflow](#)
[Workflow Context](#)

Requested Items (1)	Prices (1)						
≡ ⌵ State Approval for = REQ0... ☐ 🔍 State	@ — Actions on selected rows... Edit <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Approver</th> <th>Comments</th> <th>Created</th> </tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>Eric Schroeder</td> <td></td> <td>2024-04-17 04:07:12</td> </tr> </tbody> </table>	Approver	Comments	Created	Eric Schroeder		2024-04-17 04:07:12
Approver	Comments	Created					
Eric Schroeder		2024-04-17 04:07:12					

1 to 1 of 1

- Then click on the Requested item Section
- Open that Requested Item record

[Favorites](#)
[History](#)
[Workspaces](#)
[Admin](#)

Requested Item - RITM0010001

<

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Requested Item RITM0010001

🔗

✚

🔧

⋮

Discuss

Follow

Update

Delete

↑

↓

Activities: 1

👤

System Administrator

Impact

3 - Low

Opened by

System Administrator

Priority

4 - Low

State

Open

Field changes

2024-04-17 04:07:10

⏏

UpdateDelete

Related Links
[Flow Context](#)

Catalog Tasks (1)ApproversGroup approvals

≡

🔍

Number

Search

⚙️

—

Actions on selected rows...

New

Request item = RITM0010001

☐	🔍	Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
☐		SCTASK0010001	Hardware	(empty)	Laptop needs to Configured	2024-04-17 04:11:40	(empty)	
⏪ ⏩ 1 to 1 of 1 ⏪ ⏩								

- Scroll down to the “Catalog tasks” Section
- Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.

Catalog Task
SCTASK0010001

DiscussFollowUpdateClose TaskDelete

NumberSCTASK0010001

Assigned to

Configuration item

Active☒

ApprovalApproved

Priority4 - Low

StateOpen

Request itemRITM0010001

Requested forSystem Administrator

Short descriptionLaptop needs to Configured

DescriptionLaptop needs to Configured

Work notesWork notes

Post

Activities: 1

Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.

